

PSCI 2223

I. A. Introduction

I. What is international relations?

- ▶ A game of politics on the international level
- ▶ What is politics?
 - a game of resource allocation
 - who gets what, when, and how
- ▶ The object of global politics
 - get more of the resources you value
 - how do you accomplish this?
 - set the rules of the game
 - rules according to the US vs. China vs. Russia vs. the Netherlands vs. N. Korea vs. Palau?

IV. Where do we look for clues? What influences international events?

- ▶ Example: what caused WW II?
- ▶ Levels of analysis
 - Individual
 - State
 - Dyadic
 - Systemic

V. The State

- ▶ the dominant way of political organization
- ▶ meanings of the term “state”
 - US politics: state = Colorado
 - CP: state = government / regime
 - IR: **state = country** such as Belgium
- ▶ Examples of alternatives to states
 - Tribe
 - Feudal entity / principality
 - City–state
 - City league
 - Empire
 - European Union
 - United Federation of Planets

- ▶ When is a political entity considered a state?
- ▶ Key properties of states
 - Territory
 - Population
 - Sovereignty
 - Diplomatic recognition

VI. Where Did States Come From?

Origins of the Modern State

- ▶ Late feudal period in Europe
 - micro system of order
 - macro system of order
- ▶ Key changes
 - Gunpowder
 - Renaissance and Reformation
- ▶ 30 Years War and the Treaty of Westphalia (1648)
 - *cuius regio, eius religio* (whose realm, his religion)
- ▶ Why did the rest of the world organize into states?

VII. Reinventing the State

- ▶ French Revolution & Napoleon
 - Government should govern on behalf of the people
 - Subjects → citizens
- ▶ A potentially unintended consequence
 - Who are “the people?”
 - A community defined by some similarity → a nation
 - Birth of nationalism
 - Key nationalist agenda
 - Self-determination
 - The concept of state transformed into the one nation–one state ideal

VIII. The State Under Threat?

- ▶ How common are true nation-states?
 - The Ra'anana reading
- ▶ What is the problem if national and state boundaries do not correspond?
 - Loyalty to the state or to the nation?
 - Governing can be more difficult
 - Secessionist movements
- ▶ TA discussion topic

- ▶ In addition to the threat from below (or within), is there also a threat to the state from above?
 - How is globalization challenging the state?
 - TA discussion topic

- ▶ Some would argue that nationalism and globalization are the forces that are fundamentally reshaping the world we live in.
 - Tearing the fabric the interstate system is based on
 - High degree of instability in the coming years

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II. A. (Neo)Realism

I. Basics of Realism (per Hobbes)

- ▶ Intellectual origins
 - Hobbes, Thucydides, Machiavelli, Morgenthau
- ▶ General view of the world
 - Unlimited competition among humans to satisfy their unending wants
 - Unchecked by a higher authority, how far does this competition go?
 - State of nature is state of _____ ?
- ▶ War is normal

- ▶ In the Hobbesian competition, what determines who gets what and how much?
 - Power is the most valuable commodity
 - Dahl's definition
 - where does power come from?
 - Realist answer: military / weapons

- ▶ But, you can't always get what you want
 - So how do you know when you are well off?
 - Satisfaction is relative
 - Key goal
 - acquisition (and preservation) of relative power
 - A zero-sum view of the world

II. The International Arena (per Thucydides)

- ▶ States are much like humans
 - Greedy for power
 - Rational, preferring more power to less
 - International politics as a ceaseless and unlimited struggle for power
- ▶ How is the behavior of states checked?
 - No world government
 - Anarchy
 - (note: anarchy $\neq$ chaos)
 - Who will look after you?
 - Self-help world

- ▶ Given anarchy, relative power variations shape preferences and determine outcomes
 - “the strong do what they can and the weak suffer what they must”
 - “you and everybody else, having the same power as we have, would do the same”
 - All the countries and leaders act the same
 - Domestic politics is irrelevant
 - Stimuli come only from the outside
- ▶ Roles of non–state entities?
 - IGOs, MNCs, etc.

III. Neorealism (per Waltz)

- ▶ Looks to the international system to explain state behavior
 - The role of human nature deemphasized in favor of
 - The system structure
 - anarchy
- ▶ Given anarchy, the main goal of states is
 - Survival (security)
 - The role of power
 - Power is the means to survival (and not an end in itself)
- ▶ What do states do in the neorealist world?
 - Fight; why?
 - war is a result of states vying for power to ensure own survival
 - Can't escape the clutches of the security dilemma

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II. B. (Neo)Liberalism

I. Some Background

- ▶ Liberal theory vs. liberalism in US politics
- ▶ Intellectual origins
 - Locke, Mill, Kant, Rousseau, (US founders)
- ▶ The main strands of liberalism
 - Commercial
 - Free market, private property rights, trade
 - Republican
 - Limits on state power
 - Institutionalized rules
 - Ideational
 - Ideas, identity, legitimacy

II. Basics of Liberalism

- ▶ (contrast with realism)
- ▶ View of human nature
 - self-interested behavior / maximizing own welfare
 - what is being maximized?
 - Wealth, popularity, power, etc.
 - How do you know when you are well off?
 - absolute gains matter
- ▶ What makes the world go 'round?
 - Pursuit of (actor's) preferences
 - conflicting and harmonious
 - →interaction can benefit everyone
- ▶ Power is important, but
 - Not all-important and not necessarily about military power
 - Can be derived from institutions

III. The International Arena

- ▶ Major actors
 - Anything expressing people's preferences
 - states, MNCs, IOs, groups, individuals
 - state as a unitary actor?
- ▶ Int'l politics as an extension of domestic politics
- ▶ Anarchy
 - (neo)realists
 - A huge problem, leads to war
 - liberals
 - Presents problems, but not insurmountable
 - makes contracts hard to keep / cheating
 - solution
 - Repeated interactions, institutionalized rules, enforcement mechanisms
 - e.g. WTO

IV. Examples of Liberal Concerns

- ▶ Minimizing war
- ▶ Enhancing
 - Economic relations
 - The rule of law
 - Human rights
- ▶ Typically achieved through the building of (international) institutions
- ▶ Coming up later in the semester

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II. C. Marxism

I. Fundamentals of Marxism

▶ Intellectual origins

- Developed as a critique of 19th century capitalism
- Marx, Engels, (Lenin, Mao)

▶ An economic theory

- Econ is a relationship between two classes
 - The owners of the means of production (the exploiters)
 - The producers (the exploited)
- Who benefits from economic relations?
 - Inevitable and fixed zero-sum outcomes

▶ Politics

- An outgrowth of the economic relations between the two classes
 - The role of the state?
 - (“tool of the oppressor”)

- ▶ War as an outgrowth of class-based systems
 - Wars fought to acquire wealth, resources, markets
 - Benefit the owners, hurts labor
 - Similar view of other international interactions
 - Trade done to increase profits and push wages down
 - IOs developed to keep poorer countries down
 - Who has the power within the UN, IMF, WTO, etc.?
- ▶ Marxism's main goal
 - End the economic exploitation to create a classless society
 - Means
 - Educate the exploited about their position
 - get rid of the “false consciousness” of religion, ethnic identity, etc.
 - Violent revolution
 - Role of the state post-revolution?

▶ Some criticisms

- Why have there been no communist countries?
 - Socialism vs. communism
 - Is socialism to communism transition possible?
- A good understanding of human nature?
- Theory vs. reality
 - What were the first socialist countries and why?

▶ The three IR theories and their audiences

- realism
 - powerful states
- liberalism
 - wealthy states, democracies
- Marxism
 - The underdeveloped part of the world